Jona Melvin **Grobe**



CG Generalist & Technical Artist

jonamelvingrobe@gmail.com · Passau, Germany · (+49) 0152 07729385
Portfolio & Showreel: jmelving.de · crossdot.studio · LinkedIn · YouTube · GitHub

PROFILE

CG Generalist and Technical Artist, co-founder of CrossDot. Houdini at the core, comfortable across the full production stack. Currently finishing a master's thesis on AI-assisted previs pipelines. Contributes to the CG community through educational video content. Available from September 2026.

EXPERIENCE

CG Generalist & Technical Artist *Dec 2025 – Present*
CrossDot · Freelance

- Motion design and advertisement projects with a focus on Houdini-based workflows
- Building tools and connecting software across the pipeline to implement and extend features

Nuke Compositor *Sep – Dec 2023*
recom FILM GmbH & Co. KG · Internship, Stuttgart

- Retouch, clean-up, object replacement and CG integration into live footage

Freelance Artist *Jun 2019 – Present*
Self-employed

- Ongoing freelance work across 3D, compositing, motion design and editing

EDUCATION

M.A. Realtime Art & Visual Effects *Sep 2024 – Sep 2026*
Salzburg University of Applied Sciences

- Thesis: From Storyboard to USD Scene: Building and Evaluating a Locally-Deployed AI Pipeline for Automated 3D Previsualization

B.A. MultiMediaArt, Computeranimation *Jun 2021 – Aug 2024*
Salzburg University of Applied Sciences

- Thesis 1: Music Visualization Techniques in Houdini
- Thesis 2: Procedural Terrain Generation

SKILLS

3D / VFX
Houdini (FX, Sim, USD, PDG, HDAs), Blender, UE5

Compositing & Motion Graphics
Nuke, After Effects, DaVinci Resolve

AI / Generative
ComfyUI, local model integration

Languages
German (native), English (C1-C2)

RECOGNITIONS

- ★ Selected for SideFX Houdini Student Reel
- ★ Featured on SideFX Official Instagram
- ★ Best Music Video – "Painting Greys" w/ H. Rampitsch, L. Schibany, M. Supersberger (IMV Awards: "Best Animation Music Video"; Cinema Next Tour & BRAVÖ HITS '25 "Favorite Movie of the Night")
- ★ VFX contributor on "The USB Paradox" – ADC Young Ones Gold Cube, ADCE Youngstar
- ★ Merit scholarship, Realtime Arts & Visual Effects 2025, Salzburg University of Applied Sciences
- ★ Invited speaker, FMX School Presentations (Painting Greys (2025) & CrossDot (2026))
- ★ Multiple BAAF nominations – Painting Greys, No Need to Rush Life, Echoes
- ★ Selected Top 100 – Pwnisher Challenge (2021)